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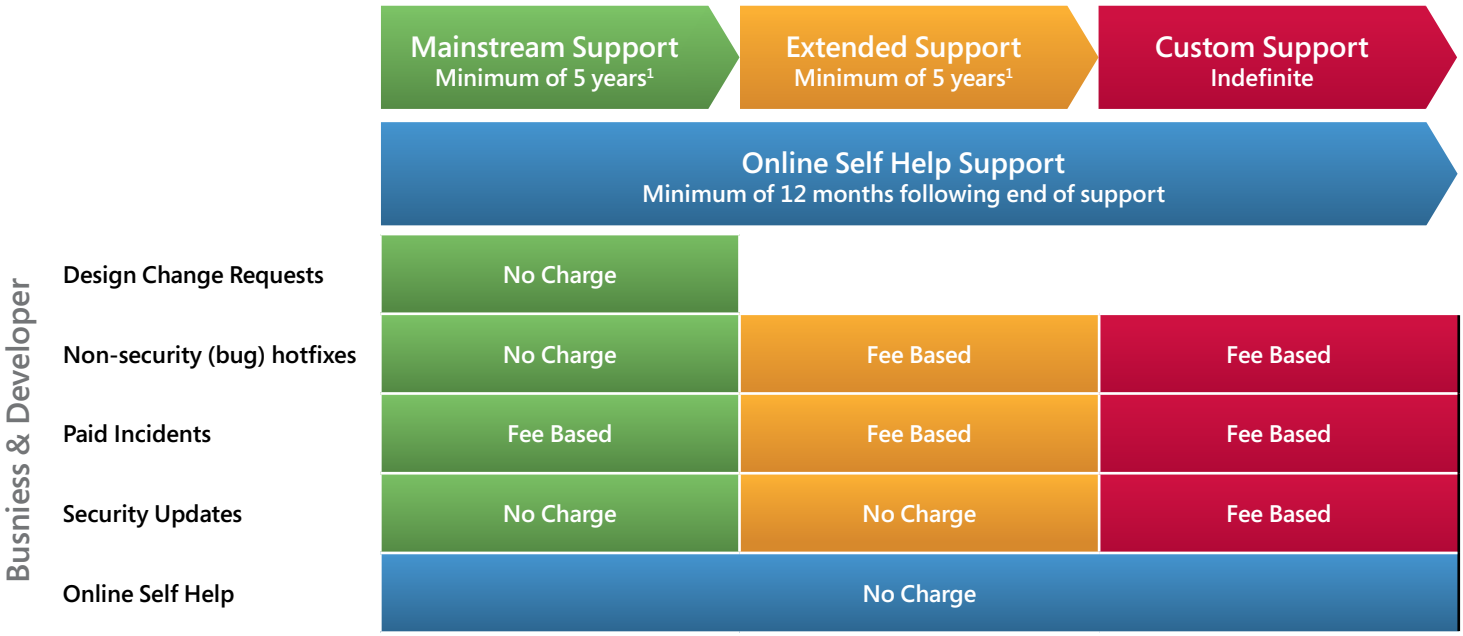
Microsoft® SQL Server®

Understanding the SQL Server Support Lifecycle—Maximize Investments and Plan for the Future

Understanding the SQL Server support lifecycle can help you maximize the management of your IT investments and plan for a successful IT future. Avoid the risk of running unsupported products and make sure you are running the right version of SQL Server for your business by learning about important support events.

Microsoft Support Lifecycle Policy

Microsoft offers a minimum of 10 years of support for SQL Server products. Mainstream Support is provided for 5 years or for 2 years after the successor product is released, whichever is longer. Microsoft also provides Extended Support for the 5 years following Mainstream support or for 2 years after the second successor product is released, whichever is longer. And you receive at least 10 years of online self-help support.



Support is only provided at the supported service pack level.

1 Mainstream Support Ends after 5 years ,or 2 years after the successor product is released (N+1), whichever is longer
2 Extended Support ends after 5 years or 2 years after the second successor product is released (N+2), whichever is longer.

Learn More

To learn more about the SQL Server support lifecycle, explore what version of SQL Server is right for your business, and access tools to help you upgrade, visit the SQL Server Support Updates page: microsoft.com/sqlserver/en/us/support

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SQL Server End of Support Events:

Avoid the risk of running unsupported products and make sure you are running the right version of SQL Server for your business by learning about important support events.

Find out what's happening with your version of SQL Server:

SQL Server 2000

On April 9, 2013, Extended Support for SQL Server 2000 ends, and SQL Server 2000 will no longer be supported. **At this time:**

- Updates to this software will stop and you will no longer receive patches including security updates
- Self-Help Online Support will be available for a minimum of 12 months after Extended Support ends

Your Options:

- Upgrade to a supported version of SQL Server
- Find out more about a Custom Support Agreement
- Run SQL Server 2000 with Self-Help Online Support only (not recommended)

SQL Server 2005

On April 12, 2011, SQL Server 2005 transitions from Mainstream Support to Extended Support. **Extended support includes:**

- Paid support (charged on an hourly basis per incident)–You will no longer receive no-charge incident support and warranty claims, and won't be able to request design changes or features
- Security update support at no additional cost
- Non-security related hotfix support will require a separate Extended Hotfix Support Agreement to be purchased within 90 days of the end of Mainstream Support – July 11th, 2011

Your Options:

- Remain on SQL Server 2005 with Extended Support–You can still open support incidents and receive support, however you will not be able to request specific fixes
- Remain on SQL Server 2005 with Extended Support and purchase Extended Hotfix Support[i], which must be purchased within 90 days of the end of Mainstream Support – July 11th, 2011
- Upgrade to a supported version of SQL Server[ii]

SQL Server 2008 & 2008 R2

SQL Server 2008 and SQL Server 2008 R2 will be supported until January 8, 2019, and will transition from Mainstream Support to Extended Support on January 14, 2014.

SQL Server 2008 R2

This could be a great time to get the most powerful version of SQL Server ever: Microsoft SQL Server 2008 R2. Upgrading to SQL Server 2008 R2 provides you with new features and capabilities that can help your organization scale with confidence on a trusted platform, improve IT and developer efficiency, and makes self-service business intelligence possible—and Extended Support lasts into 2019.

What's New with SQL Server 2008 R2

SQL Server 2008 R2 contains a number of new features, enhancements, and tools that make it an attractive upgrade from previous versions of SQL Server. Here are some highlights:

- Enjoy improved reporting and analytics
- Gain IT and developer efficiencies
- Develop complex event-processing (CEP) applications
- Get enterprise-scale support for numerous workloads

Find out more about SQL Server 2008 R2 at: microsoft.com/sql

i Available for Premier Support customers.

ii Talk to your application provider about moving your application to a supported version of SQL Server.

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